CROCHET PATTERN

Blush Butterfly Hanging Ornament

A two-colour crochet butterfly on a beaded cord with a striped tassel



SKILL LEVEL	FINISHED SIZE	YARN	HOOK
Intermediate	≈ 18 cm (7 in) plus an 8 cm loop	DK cotton · 2 colours	2.5 mm (US B/1–C/2)

Four teardrop wings worked as stitch fans in a magic ring and edged in cream, joined with a wrapped body and knotted antennae, and hung on a beaded cord above a cream-and-pink tassel.

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MATERIALS · GAUGE · ABBREVIATIONS

Before You Begin

Materials & Tools

Yarn A (wing edges, body, tassel, cord)	DK (#3) cotton, cream — approx. 11 m (12 yd), about 5 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn B (wing centres, tassel)	DK (#3) cotton, dusty pink — approx. 6 m (6 yd), about 3 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Hook	2.5 mm (US B/1–C/2)
Beads	3 gold-tone beads 6 mm (hole at least 2.5 mm); 2 natural wooden beads 12 mm (hole at least 3 mm). Both cord strands must pass through each bead together — test before you start.
Notions	fabric glue (optional), tapestry needle, stiff card, scissors

Gauge

GAUGE 22 sc and 24 rows/rnds = 10 cm (4 in) in single crochet with a 2.5 mm hook. Gauge is not critical for an ornament, but work firmly so that stuffing does not show and flat pieces keep their shape; sizes depend on your tension.

How to swatch: Optional density check: ch 12, then work 10 rows of sc on 11 sts. The square should measure about 5 cm (2 in) wide and 4 cm (1.6 in) tall. If it is larger or you see gaps between stitches, use a smaller hook.

Finished Measurements

Part	Width	Height
Butterfly (wingspan)	≈ 5.5 cm (2.2 in)	≈ 4.5 cm (1.8 in) with antennae
Tassel	–	9 cm (3.5 in)

CHOOSING A SIZE One size. For a larger ornament use light worsted (#4) cotton and a 3 mm hook; for a smaller one use sport-weight cotton and a 2 mm hook. Beads and tassel length can be changed freely.

Abbreviations (US terms)

ch	chain	**tr**	treble crochet (yo twice)
sc	single crochet	**MR**	magic ring
inc	2 sc in the same stitch	**st(s)**	stitch(es)
sl st	slip stitch	**rnd(s)**	round(s)
hdc	half double crochet	**( ) xN**	work the sequence in brackets N times
dc	double crochet		

Pattern Notes

- Terms: US crochet terms are used throughout; UK makers: US sc is the UK double crochet.
- Stitch counts: the number in parentheses at the end of a row or round is the number of stitches you have when it is finished. Tick the box when you finish each step.
- Spiral rounds (magic-ring pieces with no "Join"): do not join or turn; mark the first stitch of each round and move the marker up.
- Joined rounds (the round says "Join"): unless the round says otherwise, start with ch 1 (does not count as a stitch) and finish with a sl st into the first stitch.
- Rows: ch 1 at the end of a row, before turning, does not count as a stitch.
- Right side: for pieces in rounds, the outside of the rounds; for pieces in rows, choose the neater side and mark it. "Wrong sides together" means the marked right sides face out.
- Tails: leave a 20 cm (8 in) tail on pieces that will be sewn; weave in all other ends as you go.

Techniques

Magic ring (MR) — Wrap the yarn twice around two fingers, insert the hook under both strands, pull up a loop and ch 1 (does not count as a stitch). Work the stitches of Rnd 1 over both strands, then pull the tail firmly to close the centre.

Joining new yarn with a standing sc — Make a slip knot on the hook, insert the hook in the stitch, yo, pull up a loop, yo and draw through both loops. This sc counts as the first stitch.

Tassel neck wrap — Lay a 5 cm loop of the wrapping strand along the tassel, pointing down. Wrap the long end tightly around tassel and loop, from the top down. Pass the end through the loop, then pull the short tail at the top until the loop disappears under the wraps. Trim both ends and hide them in the skirt.

Order of Work

- Read Before You Begin and gather the beads; check that both cord strands pass through every bead.
- Crochet: Wings.
- Crochet: Body and Antennae.
- Make the tassel and tie the hanging cord into it (Tassel).
- String beads and pieces on the cord, tie the knot and the hanging loop (Assembly & Finishing).

YARN B (PINK) AND YARN A (CREAM)

Wings

Each wing is a fan of graded stitches worked into a magic ring and pulled into a teardrop, then edged with one round of cream sc.

Upper wings (make 2)

☐	**Rnd 1**	With Yarn B, make a MR, ch 2 (does not count). In the ring work sc 1, hdc 1, dc 2, tr 3, dc 2, hdc 1, sc 1. Pull the ring closed and join with a sl st to the first sc. Fasten off Yarn B.	**(11)**
☐	**Rnd 2**	Join Yarn A with a standing sc in the first sc; sc 1, (inc, sc 1) x3, inc, sc 2. Join with a sl st to the first sc. Fasten off, leaving a 20 cm tail.	**(15)**

Lower wings (make 2)

☐	**Rnd 1**	With Yarn B, make a MR, ch 2 (does not count). In the ring work sc 1, hdc 1, dc 4, hdc 1, sc 1. Pull the ring closed and join with a sl st to the first sc. Fasten off Yarn B.	**(8)**
☐	**Rnd 2**	Join Yarn A with a standing sc in the first sc; (inc, sc 1) x3, sc 1. Join with a sl st to the first sc. Fasten off, leaving a 20 cm tail.	**(11)**

YARN A (CREAM)

Body and Antennae

☐	**Step 1**	Lay the wings right side up: the two upper wings with their pointed (ring) ends meeting at the centre and tilted up, the two lower wings below them with their points also at the centre. Sew all four points together with the tails.
☐	**Step 2**	Body: fold a 12 cm strand of Yarn A into a 3 cm bundle of 4 strands and lay it vertically over the centre on the front. Wrap a 1 m length of Yarn A tightly round the bundle and the wing centres, from top to bottom, each wrap next to the last, until the wraps cover 2.4 cm (about 12–14 wraps). Sew the end into the back.
☐	**Step 3**	Antennae: thread a 15 cm strand of Yarn A under the top wrap of the body so both halves stand up. Tie an overhand knot in each half 1.5 cm from the body and trim 2 mm above the knot. A drop of fabric glue keeps the antennae upright.

YARN A (CREAM) AND YARN B (PINK)

Tassel

Make the tassel when the crochet pieces are finished. The hanging cord is tied into its top, so it runs up through the whole ornament and is anchored in the tassel.

☐	**Step 1**	Cut a piece of stiff card 10 cm (3.9 in) tall. Wrap Yarn A around the card 28 times, then Yarn B 12 times spread across the card between the cream wraps (40 wraps). Cut the yarn at the bottom edge.
☐	**Step 2**	Cut the hanging cord: one 90 cm (35 in) length of Yarn A. Slide it under all the wraps along the top edge of the card so that its middle sits there, and tie it in a tight square knot around the wraps. Both cord ends now point upwards.
☐	**Step 3**	Cut through all the wraps along the bottom edge of the card and remove the card. Let the strands hang down from the cord knot.
☐	**Step 4**	Tassel neck: cut a 70 cm length of Yarn B. Measure 2 cm down from the top fold and wrap it tightly 8 times around the bundle (see Tassel neck wrap in Techniques).
☐	**Step 5**	Trim the skirt evenly to 9 cm (3.5 in) from the top fold. Hold it over steam (or dampen it) and comb the strands straight with your fingers; let it dry hanging.

Assembly & Finishing

- Thread both cord ends together through a large-eye tapestry needle (or a bead needle with a big eye). Work upwards from the tassel.
- String, from the tassel upwards: 1 wooden bead → 1 gold bead → the butterfly → 1 gold bead → 1 wooden bead → 1 gold bead.
- Butterfly: push the needle up through the body wraps from the bottom to the top, between the antennae.
- Push everything down snugly onto the tassel so there are no gaps. Holding both cord ends together, tie one overhand knot right above the top bead to lock the stack.
- Hanging loop: tie the two cord ends together with a square knot so that the loop measures 8 cm (3 in) from the overhand knot to the top. Trim the ends to 5 mm and add a drop of fabric glue to the knot if you like.

SAFETY This is a decoration, not a toy, and not suitable for children under 3 years. Beads and cords are a choking and strangling hazard: hang it out of reach of babies, young children and pets.

Checkpoints & Troubleshooting

Count your stitches at these points; the numbers match the rows above.

Piece	After	Stitches
Upper wings (make 2)	Rnd 1	11
Upper wings (make 2)	Rnd 2	15
Lower wings (make 2)	Rnd 1	8
Lower wings (make 2)	Rnd 2	11

- One stitch too many or too few: check the last increase or decrease round, and that you did not work into the slip-stitch join or the ch 1 at the start of a row.
- Piece cups or ripples: your tension differs from the gauge; change hook size by 0.25–0.5 mm rather than the stitch counts.
- Stuffing shows through: use a smaller hook, or stuff a little less firmly.
- Flat pieces curl: pin them out, mist with water (or starch) and let them dry flat.
- Cord will not pass through a bead: thread one strand at a time with a fine needle, or use beads with larger holes.

THANK YOU Thank you for making this ornament. Happy crocheting!